Chinese benevolence and indulgence. For its part, India would be expected to give China its loyalty and support on issues that matter to Beijing.

China's communist perspective on the world also would have India in a secondary or subordinate role. For all the talk of fraternal relations between socialist partners that communism trumpets, some revolutionary partners are more important than others in the global struggle against capitalism. They guide and lead; others follow. While the CPC is no longer much of a communist party ideologically, in this perspective China is the leader of the developing world. It is revealing that despite its spectacular economic advance over the past forty years, Beijing continues to insist on being recognized as a developing country, a status it clings to for political and diplomatic reasons. India in this view is a junior partner in the international system, though once again a junior partner with heft of its own. As a major economy and as a long-time member of various developing-country coalitions in multilateral forums, India has influence in ways that other developing countries do not. It can stand with China on issues such as climate change, trade, humanitarian intervention, and internet and cyber protocols, where Beijing is often in contention against the Western powers.

In this hierarchical view, China would expect to lead in formulating the developing world's positions on global issues, just as in the early years of the Cold War it sought to be the leader of the global communist movement. Its split with Moscow beginning in the 1950s was partly over the withdrawal of Soviet assistance to its nuclear programme. More importantly, though, Beijing regarded Moscow as increasingly timid in confronting Washington. In Mao's view, the Soviets were wrong to believe that nuclear weapons necessitated strategic caution and a tempering of socialist radicalism. Almost from the beginning, and certainly after Josef Stalin's death, China wanted to lead the communist movement, just as it now wants to lead the developing world. Beijing certainly cedes no ground to Delhi as a leader of the global south; indeed, it has gradually increased its influence among the various coalitions of the non-aligned/developing countries.